



The Case of the Missing Brain

A brain out of 300 brains stored in the Smithsonian Museum of Washington, DC, had been receiving more attention lately. In 1911 last member of Yahi tribe named Ishi came out of California Wilderness and befriended by anthropologists. Ishi shared his language, belief and tribal arts with anthropologists, during his stay at University of California San Francisco Campus. Ishi died of TB in 1960. His ashes was placed in the city just south of San Francisco but his brain was not buried with him. According to American law the remains of native Americans must be rewarded to their tribe descendants, but Ishi had no direct descendants. According to an article Ishi's brain had been removed during autopsy and sent to the Smithsonian Museum. Northern Californian Indians had proposed that they will bury the Ishi's remains in the area where the Ishi's tribe once lived. Smithsonian Museum had also launched a search for Ishi's descendants and in result they have found nine Americans who claim to have descended from the Yana, a sub-tribe of the Yahi. Lately some researchers claimed that Ishi was not full Yahi, but may be half Maidu or Wintu.

Dial F for Fear

Technological advancements have produced many health scares in our society. Have you thought! Blast of heat emitted by hairdryer can cause memory loss and brain cancer. People relentlessly worry about pesticides in food, sperm count and safety of kid walking to school. Era of mobile phones have spread fear of microwave radiations causing cancer and memory loss. Journalists went to explore if it is true and asked scientists researching on the topic but did not found compelling evidence. People tend to believe the bad news because fear gets better of them. In past few years experiments suggested mobile phone emissions may cause cancer and damage DNA but several experiments purposing them harmless are

ignored. Our society tends to believe on superstitions, although it has been proved that radiations emitting from TV towers and microwaves do not cause leukemia, silicon breast implants do not cause auto immune disease yet campaigns against them grow by the coming day. It has always been the same, first it was X-rays from TV-tubes then electromagnetic fields from computer and when internet was introduced, internet addiction syndrome was common. So nowadays threat of hairdryers is out of order in this highly technological advanced world and no one wants to pay any heed to it, amidst of newer **advancements taking place every day.**

Sweet dreams made by machine

Now **technology** is helping the people to shape the dreams according to their desires. A **nightmare banisher** has been named Yumemi Kobo, 35 inches tall made for dream workshop by Japanese **Takara**. It was equipped with a voice recorder, array of lights, picture frame, fragrance dispenser, music, two **speakers** and a timer. These components **allow** to design dreams according to their desire by sitting with it for **few** minutes. First user attach a **photo** of desire **dream** to machine. Then the user starts to concentrate on the **image**. Next they spread a **scent** and play a logically selected music which **relaxes** people the most. Then machine starts to do its work. The machine is **set to activate** **periodically** according to user's REM sleep, the state when the **dreamer** is at its most active. Eight hours later, sleep time is over. The dream machine awakens its honor without surprising him causing dream to be forgotten. This machine also had a drawback that there is no biofeedback. It cannot tell when REM occurs. Psychologists and dream expert Veronica Tonay, lecturer at the University of California at Santa Cruz, also gave the Yumemi Kobo concept a mixed review. Yumemi Kobo will launch in Japan in May 2004 at a cost of 14,800 yen. Takara expects the dream machine to hit American stores in early 2005.

Otzi the Iceman

Icy heights climbing had been found thousands of years ago. It was proved when a mummy of a man found on Schnalstal glacier in 1991. It was examined for several years by researchers. For the first time in the history a glacier mummy was examined. Except his left hip region the body was practically intact, but modern procedure helped to examine it. The clothes and equipments of the iceman showed the culture of Alps during copper age. His clothing was composed of a cap, hide coat, grass cloak, leggings, belt, loincloth and a pair of shoes, no woven material was used except tanned leather and a grass cloak. He was fully equipped for his last journey and he was in the condition that he could repair any damaged part of his equipments. Ice man was preserved in a cold chamber. The mummy was kept at temperature of 6°C and air humidity of 98%. Visitors can see the mummy through a small window.

The Extinction Crisis

The human species, one of millions of life forms on this planet, is threatening the existence of many other species. Explosive human population growth is causing loss of biodiversity (variety of life form). The rate of population growth is very high as compared to the past and never before have so many species been threatened with extinction. According to scientists the rate of species extinction is one per day. In past extinction events were caused by natural un-balance in the environment but now they are caused by human activities. If human beings keep on doing the activities which are the causes of extinction, it will be difficult for new species to evolve. Human beings directly or indirectly depend upon the other species. They are the basic needs of human beings. The stability of the ecosystem depends upon the large number of species. The species which are important for the health of ecosystem are called "keystone

species”, because their removal can greatly affect the entire system. For example when hunters eliminated sea otters that eat Kelp, cause the disappearance of fish and the other animals which are associated with Kelp beds. Animals are not only the part of ecosystem but also the part of culture and religion. Now people began to think about the decline of wildlife. Wildlife laws have passed to control illegal hunting, like international regulation of whaling. Now people started to give importance to other species.

Kaspar Hauser

On March 6th, 1828 in Nuremberg a young boy appeared in a peasant dress. He carried a letter in his hand. The letter was addressed to the captain of the regiment by a poor laborer. It said that he adopted this young man when he was left by someone at his door on 7th October, 1812. After that he fed him well for 16 years and now the boy wants to serve his King.

When Kaspar got examined by the doctor, it was discovered that he did not develop like a normal human. He did not use his fingers properly while eating. He spoke like a three years old child. After much consideration it became known that Kaspar had spent the 16 years of his life in a prison. That's why he could not learn anything from his environment.

Kaspar had developed a very basic form of perception. For example, he called a man with big fat belly “a man with mountain” or a lady whose shawl dragged beside her was “a lady with tail”. He preferred bread and water over meat and alcohol.

In 1829, Kaspar moved to live with his foster parents (Herr Daumer) and there he enhanced writing and speaking skills. After learning to write, he decided to write about his past. But as this was something someone did not want to be revealed he experienced an assassination attack. In 1833 he

was stabbed in a park and his secrets died with him.

Don't put mothers behind bars

Rising prison suicide rate among women in prison calls for an imminent policy that gives them relief from the undermining stress and anxiety they are undergoing from the severe hardships they face. The problems of the sort of domestic violence, sexual abuse, female criminality traumatize them which cause mental instability. The scheme "home and away" introduced in two prisons gives them moral courage to survive through the tough times while they are confined in prison. Some 55% of all women in prison have kids under age of 16, so their sense of responsibility caused them disastrous stress leading them to suicide. Because of no proper undertaking of their children they worry relentlessly how their children are doing without them. That is why the little crimes like theft and shoplifting should be compensated with productive punishment for the women such as sewing, babysitting and cleaning etc.

Mars Exploration

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Robotic rovers instead of people are being sent to Mars for exploration purposes. It raises a question Why is it so? To counter this question we must know that already the expenses of sending robots is a tall order and they also don't need provisions to stay alive and only 2 out of 20 make their way to Mars. Whereas sending humans will cost exquisite sum of money, the assurance of their safety is also not guaranteed. As the engine and fuel for the return mission from Mars trip is not available. So to make it possible many test missions have to be conducted which will cost billions. That is why sending robotic rover is the best and suitable option.

Blaine drenches press in 'blood'

A majestically amusing thrill-seeker sorcerer who performs the deadliest of stunts known as the daredevil of US, while attending a conference in reference to promote his upcoming act, performed a fabulistically peculiar trick by cutting his ear with a knife and walked past journalists with his ear and top of his shirt covered with what appeared to be blood. His new trick comprises of him being hanged in a clear Plexiglas case for 44 days without any food, surviving with just water. In past he had been entombed in a block of ice, buried in a coffin and stood on top of 80-foot pillar in Manhattan for a considerably long time. This seems to be his most dangerously breathtaking stunt of his whole career. He will have writing material,diapers,pillow and a pad to lie in the box and is expected to lose 45 pounds during his act. He marked his arrival in London by perching on the roof of London Eye that is 135 metres above the ground.

PHO

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If you are Vietnam then it would not hard for you to find world's great breakfast "Pho". It is a noodle soup. The aromatic fog that wafts like a banner from the soup cauldron and over the customers is the stall's advertisement. Pho is much more than breakfast to the North Vietnamese. It is "the soul of the nation" and an addiction "worse than tobacco".

The writer gets up early for his first pho. Though Hanoi resident has a favorite pho spot but the best advice is to stop at the stall with a large crowd round it. I find Thao Van's portable restaurant. The centerpiece of Thao Van's soup stall is two huge, saucer shaped wicker baskets, both the baskets contain product of pho. I sit on the steps to watch Thao Van in action. Thao Van is busy with the ambidextrous hand

jive that marks pho production. The bowl is thrust at me with battered wooden chopsticks and porcelain spoon.

I try a sip of soup, it's amazing I asked different questions to Thao Van, but the only question she clearly answered me about dwarf-sized stools. She replied that these stools are small because "these all are gorilla restaurants" also "we Vietnamese, you know, were famous for these tactics – a small unit, highly mobile, makes an impact and then moves out fast. The portable restaurants are only illegal because they breach street-tidiness rules. Previously police hounded the street vendors because they were capitalists.

